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INVESTMENT & DILIGENCE TRACK RECORD

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VEHICLES: VC FUND + CVC

6

DEALS DILIGENCED

\$50M

LARGEST BET SIZED

~\$20M

LOSS AVOIDED ON A PASS

3-5 wk

DILIGENCE CYCLE

WOLVERINE VENTURE FUND — Michigan Ross

Investment Team Member | 2022–2024 | \$7M evergreen fund
\$50K–\$100K checks behind an established lead

B2B SaaS

Clinical workflow automation

SEED • \$4M ROUND

Lead: healthcare-focused seed fund

INVESTED

Sourced + diligence lead

Originated through the Ann Arbor and Zell Lurie founder network. Built the market map and bottom-up TAM, ran six customer reference calls, and underwrote the lead's track record in health IT at seed stage. Authored the memo and carried the recommendation to the fund vote.

Advanced Materials

Next-gen battery components

SERIES A • \$18M ROUND

Lead: tier-1 deep-tech firm

INVESTED

Diligence lead, commercial

Owned the commercial workstream: unit economics at manufacturing scale, customer qualification pipeline, and competitive positioning against incumbent chemistries. Reference-checked the founding team through two prior investors.

Consumer Marketplace

Campus services platform

SEED • \$3M ROUND

Lead: first-time micro-fund

PASSED

Sourced + diligence lead

Cohort analysis showed retention decaying sharply past D60 with revenue concentrated in two accounts, and the lead had no prior marketplace exits. Recommended against; the fund passed. The call I would most readily defend.

RAKUTEN — Corporate Venture Capital

Investments & Diligence | 2023 | Tokyo
Payments, commerce, and AI

\$50M DTC EXPANSION

KILLED

Stress-tested the plan with a 10,000-iteration Monte Carlo on CAC, churn, and payback distributions, then killed it on downside-tail evidence. Redirected capital to a B2B2C corporate-perks motion. ~\$20M loss avoided.

0.8 → 4.5

LTV:CAC

34% → 67%

D30 RETENTION

18 mo → 4 mo

PAYBACK PERIOD

68% → PASS

NPV-NEGATIVE PATHS

Cross-border payments

STRUCTURED

Take-rate and contribution-margin analysis across corridors, plus a structuring comparison of minority equity against a revenue-share partnership. Recommended the partnership route on capital efficiency.

Applied AI / commerce

DILIGENCED

Sized the attach opportunity against the existing merchant base, tested defensibility of the model layer versus incumbent providers, and flagged integration cost as the binding constraint on the synergy case.

HOW I UNDERWRITE

01

Pre-registered criteria beat narrative

Every recommendation states in advance what would make it wrong, so the later double-down or write-off is defensible, not retrofitted.

02

The counterparty is part of the asset

Co-investor, acquirer, or commercial partner: I underwrite who is on the other side as carefully as the business itself.

03

I am willing to pass loudly

The Rakuten kill and the marketplace pass are the two calls I am proudest of. A defended no is worth as much as a yes.

Companies described by sector, stage, and syndicate per fund confidentiality. Names, investment memos, and references available on request.